

1.5.3 Using Groups

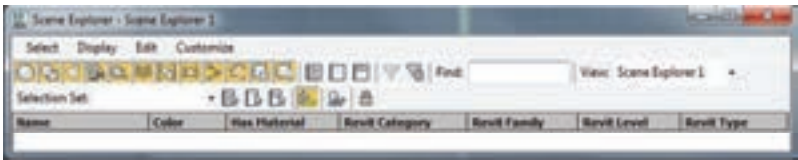
3ds Max can also combine objects into groups by using the Group menu on the main menu. Once grouped, objects appear as a single object in your scene. You can click any object in the group to select the group object, and then transform or modify it however you choose. Groups can be nested, so you can group objects, and then group again with another set of groups or objects.

1.5.4 Linking Objects into Hierarchies

3ds Max can connect objects together in a hierarchy in a way that one object can parent other objects. Moving the parent object also moves the children. Hierarchies are very useful in animation because they can attach objects to one another, so when one object moves, the rest follow. Linking is done by using the Select and Link tool on the main toolbar. Select the object or objects to be linked, and drag the link to the desired parent.

1.6 Scene Explorer

Scene Explorer is a new feature from 3ds Max 2008 onwards. It presents a comprehensive view of all the objects in a scene. Objects can be sorted, filtered, and selected from within Scene Explorer. Changes can also be made to individual objects or groups of objects. Scene Explorer is very helpful for large scenes with many objects. Scene Explorer allows you to create custom views for different types of objects, so you could have a view to display just lights and lighting parameters.



The Scene Explorer Window

Scene Explorer can be used to select objects as well as change their parameters. Object can be selected by clicking, by using selection sets, or by using the Find utility. Selected objects appear in the 3ds Max scene. You can also change parameters for selected objects by adjusting the parameters listed in the columns. The Find utility allows you to search the scene for objects that meet specific criteria. Clicking over a column for selected objects allows you to change the parameters for those objects. In this case, the colour of the highlighted objects is being changed. 